

Indirect Claim Letter: Pilgrimage Yoga Studio

You were thrilled when the Pilgrimage Yoga Studio opened in Campus Plaza during the summer before you started your freshman year. You immediately took advantage of the grand opening deal: a lifetime membership fee of \$25 per month for all SDSU students. You knew you were staying in San Diego after college, and the deal seemed too good to be true.

It was. Earlier this month, the studio's Twitter feed announced that Pilgrimage was moving to a larger facility in Kensington, and will be adding new services like massage and Pilates classes. You are a little surprised when you receive a letter this week, four months before the new studio's grand opening, offering you a new lifetime membership of \$39.99 per month. The letter says that, unfortunately, previous lifetime memberships will not be valid at the new studio and encourages you to take advantage of this great deal. You're thinking that \$39.99 per month is definitely not as great a deal as your current lifetime membership of \$25 per month, and you wonder why you would pay the increased price when you bought a "lifetime" membership not too long ago.

You call the studio and are told, "The 'lifetime' in 'lifetime membership' refers only to the life of your membership in this building. A new building means a new membership, and our new lifetime memberships are \$39.99 per month." Your mother, who is an attorney, reads the membership agreement you signed and says even though it does not specify that "lifetime" means the life of the membership in a particular building, the agreement is worded in such a way that the studio can change the terms.

This seems like a flimsy explanation for raising your monthly membership cost. In fact, it seems as though the studio is desperate for a way to raise revenue to cover the cost of the new building and services, which you don't really want, and is targeting lifetime memberships. You also feel you were misled when you signed up for a "lifetime" membership for \$25 per month.

Write a letter to the studio's owner, Josh Edwards, asking that he reconsider the new lifetime membership fee and allow yours to remain at \$25 per month.

Guidelines

As you draft the letter to Mr. Edwards, make sure you

- review the Bad-News Assignment Description
- use the appropriate approach (direct or indirect)
- describe the problem clearly, completely and with care for the reader
- present the facts in such a way to be persuasive in your quest for corrective action
- end positively and maintain goodwill

Resources

Review specific negative message types throughout Rentz chapter 6 but focus on Learning Outcome 6-4 (pp. 140-46), including all sample messages presented and discussed under that outcome.

Contact Information

Use your campus address and this address for Mr. Edwards: Josh Edwards, Pilgrimage Yoga Studio, 6150-J El Cajon Blvd., San Diego, CA 92182